

BENEFITS FRONT-DESK MAP

THE ONE RULE OVER EVERYTHING ON THIS PAGE

You may assist. You never certify to VA. — VA SCO Training FAQs, 2026-04-28

THE DESK, ON ONE PAGE — THE FULL ROWS ARE BELOW, BY NUMBER

Find the line. Do the check. Follow "then". Hand it to the role. Say the number out loud when you hand off. **You may assist. You never certify to VA.**

#	THEY SAY, OR YOU SEE	YOUR ONE CHECK	THEN	HAND TO
1	"Which benefit am I on?" — or you cannot tell	Ask for the Certificate of Eligibility or award letter, or ask "Do you have a VA counselor — VR&E?"	VR&E → Chapter 31, the counselor's lane. GI Bill (33, 30, 1606, 35, Fry) → line 3. Unsure → Post-9/11 students check online; others the COE or VA's call center. Never guess the chapter.	SCO · VRC · VA call center
2	"Do I qualify for VR&E?"	Veteran or active duty? Veteran: rating 10% or more? Active duty: 20% pre-discharge rating and leaving, or awaiting discharge for a severe illness or injury?	They may apply; the VRC decides entitlement. With a VA rating: VA Form 28-1900. A service member without a rating yet applies on VA Form 28-0588 ONLY on one of VA's three routes — in the PEB process, or expecting an other-than-dishonorable discharge with a 20%+ memorandum rating, or entered in IDES (severely injured: a separate provision). None of those, or unsure → the VRC decides; do not tell them they can apply. Veteran with no rating yet → a VSO for the claim.	VRC · VSO
3	"I registered — how do I get certified and paid?"	Chapter 31? If GI Bill: active duty, MEM Ashore or certificate program? First term here, or a change?	Ch 31: nothing to submit — the SCO watches for the authorization. Those three groups: clearance form every semester. First term or a change: clearance form with COE after registering. Continuing, unchanged: nothing — certified automatically. Chapter 35: ODU's two pages disagree — the SCO says whether the form is required.	SCO
4	"I haven't been paid."	In order: 1 certified? 2 matches the real schedule? 3 which chapter — everyone verifies monthly since Jan 2026 (Ch 31: the counselor). 4 verified this month?	Stop at the first failure. Not certified → school-side, fix today. Certified wrong → the SCO amends. Verify due → the student verifies (STEM: not by email). All clear → VA's clock, by payment: a FIRST payment lands 7–10 business days after the student verifies (about 14 days by check); a monthly Post-9/11 housing payment is processed the 1st, up to 5 days; Ch 30/1606/35 monthly pay follows the month's verification. Past that clock → VA's question, not yours.	SCO · VA call center
5	"How much will I get?"	Chapter? Ch 33: on active duty, or a spouse on transferred benefits while the Veteran serves → no housing allowance at all.	Ch 33: hand them the planner; more than half time and one class not entirely online decide <i>whether</i> and on <i>which basis</i> ; amount = basis × pursuit × tier. Ch 31: bands from the school's certified standard. Ch 30/35: bands; below half time capped at tuition and fees, may be one lump sum. Ch 1606: bands, and below half time a plain monthly row (\$123.25, FY2026) — no tuition cap.	Planner · SCO · VRC
6	"Does this class count as in person?"	Remedial or deficiency coursework? Then: required on campus at any point during the term?	Remedial → the SCO; the hybrid rule does not reach it. On campus during the term → in residence (the SCO certifies). Never → distance. Unsure → write it down for the SCO.	SCO
7	"Am I at least half time?"	Which chapter?	Ch 33: housing needs MORE than half. Ch 31: half time is a paid band; below half not payable, VA decides the exceptions. Ch 30/35: bands; below half time capped at tuition and fees, may be one lump sum. Ch 1606: bands, and below half time a plain monthly row (\$123.25, FY2026) — no tuition cap.	Planner · SCO · VRC
8	"I want to drop a class."	Chapter? Already certified or paid on? Has the class started? Inside add/drop?	Not started → the SCO removes it and reviews for a debt if certified or paid. Started, inside add/drop → a reduction from the drop date, prorated, housing debt possible. After add/drop → benefits can go back to day one unless mitigating circumstances are granted; the 6-credit exclusion applies once, and only when the student ASKS for mitigating circumstances — easiest way, tell the SCO the reasons, the SCO sends them to VA. The SCO before the drop.	SCO
9	"Can I switch benefits?"	Which chapters? One period of service that began on or after 2011-08-01?	Into Ch 31 not mid-term. Between GI Bill chapters at the next enrollment period — the SCO reads which. A single post-2011 period: one choice, irrevocable. 48 months does not count Ch 31.	VRC · SCO
10	"How much benefit do I have left?"	Which benefit were they awarded — GI Bill (30, 33, 1606, Fry), DEA (35), transferred Post-9/11, or Ch 31?	GI Bill, DEA or transferred: va.gov/education/check-remaining-benefits, their own sign-in — the page names the form (22-1990 GI Bill · 22-5490 DEA · 22-1990e transferred). Tool will not show it, claim undecided, or figure disputed → the SCO reads Enrollment Manager; VA's call center or ask.va.gov for a dispute. Ch 31 → the counselor. Never a figure from you.	SCO · VA call center
11	A Chapter 31 "training authorization" email is in the inbox	Are you the designated SCO?	No → forward it to the SCO now and confirm they saw it; say when it arrived. Yes → the authorization is permission, not proof of enrollment: check the student is registered and the courses, dates and campus match it, then certify the ENROLLMENT in Enrollment Manager. Any mismatch → line 12.	SCO
12	A Chapter 31 authorization does not match	Is the discrepancy written down and in the SCO's hands?	Write exactly what does not match; hand it to the SCO; the SCO asks the case manager on the authorization and decides. The desk never calls it "rejected".	SCO · VRC
13	Someone asks you to certify, or to enter in Enrollment Manager	Are you a designated, trained SCO?	No → you never certify. Enter data only under Assistant access an SCO granted; otherwise gather the paperwork and hand it over. Yes → certify the student's verified enrollment (program, dates, modality, hours, tuition and fees) and keep the supporting documentation; a Chapter 31 authorization is not proof of enrollment — line 11.	SCO
14	Someone wants to call Tungsten or the Financial Services Center about a payment	A student's monthly money, or the school's tuition invoice?	Student's money → stop, wrong pipeline: line 4. Invoice → the SCO or the business office.	SCO · business office

Contacts, by function — the institutions' own published routes, not a person's: ODU Military Benefits & Certification Services — office phone **757-683-7153** · office email military@odu.edu (ODU, VA education benefits (Military Benefits & Certification Services), read 2026-09-02 <<https://www.odu.edu/military-benefits/va-certifying-official>>)) · VA Education Call Center **888-442-4551** (TTY 711), Mon–Fri 8 a.m.–7 p.m. ET (va.gov payments FAQ, updated 2026-08-05 <<https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-and-other-va-education-benefit-payments-faqs/>>). Read 2026-09-02; re-read at the linked pages by 2027-08-01 (ADR-005).

THE BACK OF THE PAGE – EVERY LINE'S SOURCES

The one rule: VA SCO Training FAQs, updated 2026-04-28 <https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/resources/education_resources/school_certifying_officials/SCO_Training_FAQS.asp>. Each line below lists every VA, ODU, statute or regulation page its row cites – at the branches, in the done-when and on the source line – once each; the full row, with the sentence quoted at the branch, is on the screen version and prints from there. Printed addresses follow each link.

1 "Which benefit am I on?" – or you can't tell from what they're saying – ODU veteran student checklist < https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/veteran-student-checklist > · va.gov letters tool (Chapter 33 only, 2024-11-29) < https://www.va.gov/education/download-letters/ > · va.gov payments FAQ < https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-and-other-v-a-education-benefit-payments-faqs/ >
2 "Do I qualify for VR&E?" – or "what's the difference from my GI Bill?" – va.gov VR&E eligibility, updated 2025-11-07 < https://www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/eligibility/ > · 38 U.S.C. 3103(g) < http://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3103 > · 38 U.S.C. 3104(a)(7) < http://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3104 > · va.gov accredited representatives, 2025-01-23 < https://www.va.gov/get-help-from-accredited-representative/ > · VA VR&E program definitions, 2024-01-22 < https://www.benefits.va.gov/vocrehab/program_definition_s.asp > · va.gov, how to apply for VR&E, updated 2026-04-09 < https://www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/how-to-apply/ >
3 "Registered. What do I do to get certified and paid?" – ODU veteran student checklist, read 2026-09-02 < https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/veteran-student-checklist > · ODU military FAQs (VCF rules), read 2026-09-02 < https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/faqs >
4 "I haven't been paid." – va.gov rates page, 2026-07-31 < https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/post-9-11-gi-bill-rates/ > · va.gov enrollment verification FAQ, 2025-12-22 (consequence sentences; its scope predates January 2026) < https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-enrollment-verification-faqs/ > · benefits.va.gov/gibill, updated 2026-08-06 < https://benefits.va.gov/gibill/ > · va.gov, Verify your school enrollment, updated 2026-07-27 < https://www.va.gov/education/verify-school-enrollment/ > · ODU checklist (30=45 business days) < https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/veteran-student-checklist > · ODU VA benefits page (who is paid, by chapter) < https://www.odu.edu/military/va-certifying-official > · va.gov payments FAQ, updated 2026-08-05 < https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-and-other-v-a-education-benefit-payments-faqs/ >
5 "Am I full time?" – "How much will I get?" – "Will I get the full housing rate?" – 38 U.S.C. 3313(c)(1)(B) < https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3313 > · 38 CFR 21.9640(b)(1)(ii) < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.9640 > · 38 CFR 21.4270(c) < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.4270 > · 38 CFR 21.260(c) < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.260 > · ODU undergraduate catalog < https://catalog.odu.edu/undergraduate/registrationrequirementsandprocedures/ > · ODU graduate policies < https://catalog.odu.edu/graduate/policies/graduatepolicies/ > · va.gov MGIB-AD (Chapter 30) rates, updated 2026-06-23 < https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/montgomery-active-duty-rates/ > · va.gov MGIB-SR (Chapter 1606) rates, updated 2025-11-17 < https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/montgomery-selected-reserve-rates/ > · va.gov DEA (Chapter 35) rates, updated 2026-03-25 < https://www.va.gov/family-and-caregiver-benefits/education-and-careers/dependents-education-assistance/rates/ >
6 "Does this class count as in person?" (hybrid, online with an on-campus exam, live video) – VA Education Service, Hybrid Training Updates FAQs (September 17 questions, 2019; remedial answers pp. 1-9), read 2026-09-02 < https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/docs/presentations/Hybrid_Training_Updates_FAQS.pdf > · 38 CFR 21.4267(g) < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.4267 > · va.gov online learning, 2025-06-11 < https://www.va.gov/education/about-gi-bill-benefits/how-to-use-benefit-s/online-distance-learning/ >
7 Student is at half time or below and asks about their monthly money – 38 U.S.C. 3313(c)(1)(B)(i) < https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3313 > · 38 CFR 21.314 < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.314 > · 38 CFR 21.312 < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.312 > · va.gov MGIB-AD (Chapter 30) rates, updated 2026-06-23 < https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/montgomery-active-duty-rates/ > · va.gov MGIB-SR (Chapter 1606) rates, updated 2025-11-17 < https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/montgomery-selected-reserve-rates/ > · va.gov DEA (Chapter 35) rates, updated 2026-03-25 < https://www.va.gov/family-and-caregiver-benefits/education-and-careers/dependents-education-assistance/rates/ >

8 "I want to drop a class" – or "I'm going to withdraw" – 38 CFR 21.4200(l) < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.4200 > · 38 CFR 21.9636 < https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-38/section-21.9636 > · VA, Changes or Withdrawal of Classes, 2021 (withdrawals after the drop period) < https://benefits.va.gov/gibill/docs/Changes_Withdrawal_Article_Aug2021.pdf > · VA Education Service, December 2021 office hours, slide 20 < https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/docs/presentations/December2021_Office_Hours_Presentation.pdf > · VA Education Service, August 2021 office hours, slide 35 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/docs/presentations/August2021_Office_Hours_Presentation.pdf > · VA, Information About GI Bill Overpayments and Debts, updated 2026-05-18 < https://benefits.va.gov/gibill/resources/education_resources/debt_info.asp > · VA, Understanding Your Award Letter, 2026-02-20 < https://benefits.va.gov/gibill/understandingyourawardletter.asp > · ODU academic calendar < https://catalog.odu.edu/undergraduate/academiccalendar/academiccalendar.pdf >
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9 "Can I switch from my GI Bill to VR&E?" (or the other way, or they mix the two up) – VR&E SCO Handbook § G.3 and § G.5, updated 2025-07-30 < https://www.knowva.ebenefits.va.gov/system/templates/selfservice/va_ssnew/help/customer/locale/en-US/portal/554400000001018/content/554400000260798/VRE-School-Certifying-Official-Handbook > · va.gov change benefits < https://www.va.gov/education/change-gi-bill-benefits/ > · va.gov education eligibility (one-benefit rule), 2026-04-03 < https://www.va.gov/education/eligibility/ > · va.gov VR&E eligibility (order of use, retroactive induction) < https://www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/eligibility/ > · 38 U.S.C. 3695 < https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3695 >

10 "How much benefit do I have left?" – va.gov "Check remaining GI Bill and other education benefits", "Last updated: August 17, 2026", read in a browser 2026-09-02 < https://www.va.gov/education/check-remaining-benefits/ > · va.gov letters (2024-11-29) < https://www.va.gov/education/download-letters/ > · VA Education Office Hours, Enrollment Manager quick tips (updated 2025-06-04) < https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/office_hours/april-education-office-hours-fiscal-year-2023.asp > · Enrollment Manager system updates, 2026-03-07 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/enrollment-manager/enrollment-manager-system-updates.asp > · va.gov payments FAQ < https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-and-other-v-a-education-benefit-payments-faqs/ >

11 An email from VA about a Chapter 31 "training authorization" is in the inbox – today's, or one you just found from last month – 38 U.S.C. 3684(a)(1) < https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title38-section3684 > · VR&E SCO Handbook § G.1-G.3, updated 2025-07-30 < https://www.knowva.ebenefits.va.gov/system/templates/selfservice/va_ssnew/help/customer/locale/en-US/portal/554400000001018/content/554400000260798/VRE-School-Certifying-Official-Handbook > · VA, Certification Basics for new SCOs, updated 2026-06-02 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/SCO/new-sco/certification-basics.asp > · VA, First-Year SCO Scenarios, updated 2026-06-10 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/SCO/new-sco/first-year-scenarios.asp >
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12 A Chapter 31 authorization does not match (wrong program, wrong campus, wrong dates, wrong facility code) – VR&E SCO Handbook § G.2 (authorization notification), updated 2025-07-30 < https://www.knowva.ebenefits.va.gov/system/templates/selfservice/va_ssnew/help/customer/locale/en-US/portal/554400000001018/content/554400000260798/VRE-School-Certifying-Official-Handbook >
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13 Someone asks you to certify, or to enter something in Enrollment Manager – VA SCO Training FAQs, 2026-04-28 < https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/resources/education_resources/school_certifying_officials/SCO_Training_FAQS.asp > · VA, gaining access to Enrollment Manager, 2025-08-01 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/SCO/new-sco/gaining-access-to-enrollment-manager.asp > · VA, Certification Basics for new SCOs, updated 2026-06-02 < https://benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/SCO/new-sco/certification-basics.asp >
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14 Someone wants to call Tungsten or the "Financial Services Center" about a student's payment – VA Financial Services Center, e-Invoice / Tungsten Network, updated 2026-05-07 < https://www.fsc.va.gov/einvoice.asp > · VR&E SCO Handbook § G.2 < https://www.knowva.ebenefits.va.gov/system/templates/selfservice/va_ssnew/help/customer/locale/en-US/portal/554400000001018/content/554400000260798/VRE-School-Certifying-Official-Handbook >
